

1245 ▶ 1345

The earliest manuscript of Song Ci's *The Washing Away of Wrongs* is from 1408. This example is from the 19th century.



1247

Work on forensic medicine

Song Ci, a Chinese lawyer, wrote *The Washing Away of Wrongs*—the world's first work on forensic medicine (the use of scientific knowledge in crime investigation). His aim was to improve the evidence presented in legal cases, particularly of murder. He collected information about past cases and was critical about the unreliable tests traditionally conducted by court officers.

1286

Eyeglasses

In the 13th century, scientists began experiments with magnifying objects using glass lenses. In 1286, Italian friar Giordano da Pisa gave the first description of lenses used as spectacles. Early eyeglasses corrected farsightedness, a particular problem for monks and friars who often had to read and write manuscripts in dim light.



French clergyman wears eyeglasses for close work.

1245



Seeds from poppy head

1260

Using anesthetics

In his groundbreaking medical writings, Italian surgeon Teodorico Borgognoni discussed many aspects of surgery and the care of wounds. Using an early form of anesthesia, he sedated his patients before operations with sponges soaked in opium or other sleep-inducing herbs.

1269

Magnetic force

French scholar Pierre de Marincourt described the lines of magnetic force surrounding a magnet. He showed that a compass has two poles, and that oppositely charged magnetic poles attract each other, while similarly charged poles repel (push apart) each other.

Healing people
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76–77



Mandrake root

A solution made with ingredients such as opium poppy seeds or mandrake root was soaked on a sponge and given to patients to make them sleep.

“Then the stone that you hold in your hand will appear to flee the floating stone.”

Pierre de Marincourt on magnetic repulsion, *Epistola de Magnete*, 1269

Dial marked in degrees

Magnetized needle

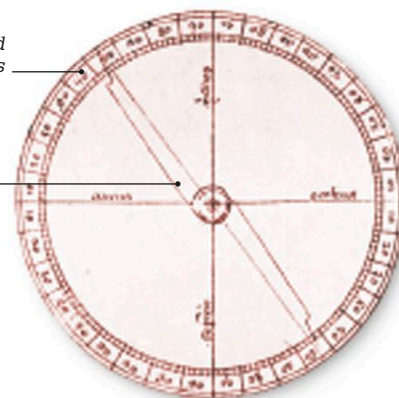


Diagram of a needle compass, from de Marincourt's *Epistola de Magnete* (Letter on the Magnet)